



Optimise speed

Making your PC faster?

Disabling these 3 hidden Windows settings does it

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When we think about what makes a computer feel fast, we usually focus on hardware upgrades, storage space, or cleaning up unused apps. What many people do not realise is that Windows itself runs dozens of background services that consume system resources. Most of them are designed to support a wide range of users, from home users and students to large corporations and government organisations. That means your PC may be running features you have never used and never will. Curious about what was happening behind the scenes on my own computer, I reviewed several Windows services and found four that served no purpose in my daily workflow. I disabled all of them, and my Windows device suddenly felt so much faster.



1. Print Spooler

The first service I disabled was the Print Spooler. The feature has a simple job: whenever you send a docu-

ment, photo, or webpage to a printer, it manages that request and sends it to the printer. For me, printing is non-existent, as most of the documents are digital and are stored in the cloud or viewed on a screen. That made me wonder why a printing service was always running in the background.

But just to be clear, disabling it did not suddenly transform my PC into a speed machine, as while the service was unnecessary in my case, it is fair to say that it does not consume a huge amount of system resources.

Furthermore, way back in 2021 scammers were using the feature to take over your device. Microsoft fixed the vulnerability, it showed how much access a service like Print Spooler has within Windows. Once disabled, you'll not be able to print anything at all unless you go and enable it again.

To disable the Print Spooler service, I pressed Windows + R and typed 'services'. MSc. Under the 'Services' tab, I discovered 'Print Spooler', which I opened. I do not have a printer on my

computer, so I chose 'Stop' and set the startup type as 'Disabled'.



2. Smart Card

The second service that was not useful for me was the Smart Card. It enables Windows to interact with the physical smart card used in identity and secure logins. It is common to see these systems in government, military organisations, healthcare institutions, and big companies.

This functionality is important for the enterprise users. However, for a typical home user, it is often irrelevant. Moreover, when I looked at my own usage, neither I nor anyone from my family connected any kind of smart card reader on my Windows device.

In the Services window, I found the Smart Card option and opened it. I stopped the service, changed the startup type to disabled, and clicked Apply and then went about my day.



3. Windows Search

Aside from the abovementioned, I also disabled the Windows Search feature on my device. Unlike the other services on this list, Windows Search serves a purpose that almost everyone uses. The feature is a lifesaver when you have to search for files, folders, and other data which are indexed just to open them instantly.

However, after a careful review and reading about it, I found that while the feature is useful, the indexing consumes resources, as it requires scanning of files on a regular basis, which may lead to increased disc usage, memory usage, and CPU usage.

Moreover, I also had another issue with Windows Search, as even when the indexing was enabled, I often found the search experience inconsistent. Sometimes it worked perfectly while at other times it struggled to find files that I knew existed. **id**

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